

SYNTH-05: Synthetic Network Monitoring

Series: SYNTH — Synthetic Monitoring | **Notebook:** 5 of 6 | **Created:** December 2025 | **Last Updated:** 09/18/2026

Network Availability, DNS, and ICMP Monitoring

This notebook covers Dynatrace Synthetic **Network Availability Monitors** (multi-protocol monitors), which test ICMP (ping), DNS, and TCP port reachability.

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Prerequisites

-  Access to a Dynatrace environment with Synthetic Monitoring
-  Completed SYNTH-01 through SYNTH-04
-  Private synthetic locations (for internal network monitoring)

⚠️ **Data model — read first:** ICMP, DNS, and TCP checks are **not** separate monitor types in Grail. They are protocols within a single **network availability monitor** (a *multi-protocol monitor*). In the data model:

- **Entity (classic):** `dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor` — deprecated in DQL, supported for as long as Dynatrace Classic is supported
- **Entity (Smartscape, preferred):** node type `NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR` (model `dt.smartscape.network_availability_monitor`) — note the **name changed**; it is *not* `MULTIPROTOCOL_MONITOR`
- **Events:** `fetch dt.synthetic.events | filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"`
- **Metric:** `dt.synthetic.multi_protocol.executions` (execution count, by `dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor`)
- **Success/failure:** `result.state ( SUCCESS / FAIL ) / result.status.code` — same as other monitor types

The rename is the trap here. Of the four synthetic classic entities, this is the one whose Smartscape node type cannot be derived from its classic name — `multiprotocol_monitor` became `NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR`, matching the product's UI name rather than the old internal one. `smartscapeNodes "MULTIPROTOCOL_MONITOR"` raises **no error**; it returns zero rows, which is indistinguishable from an environment that has no network monitors. If a Smartscape network-monitor query comes back empty, confirm the node type spelling before concluding you have nothing to monitor. (SaaS 1.344, released 07/27/2026 with a staged tenant rollout from 07/29/2026, is what makes `dt.smartscape.*` the primary surface for the Synthetic app — verify it has reached your tenant; the node type is queryable via DQL either way. FAQ-16 covers the general migration mechanics.)

The **protocol-specific measurement fields** (per-protocol latency, packet loss, resolved IP, DNS resolution time) are not published as stable metric keys and their exact `result.statistics.*` names vary by protocol. Run the discovery query in the next cell against your own tenant to see the fields your multi-protocol monitors actually emit before building latency/packet-loss queries.

1. Network Monitoring Overview

Synthetic Network Availability Monitors

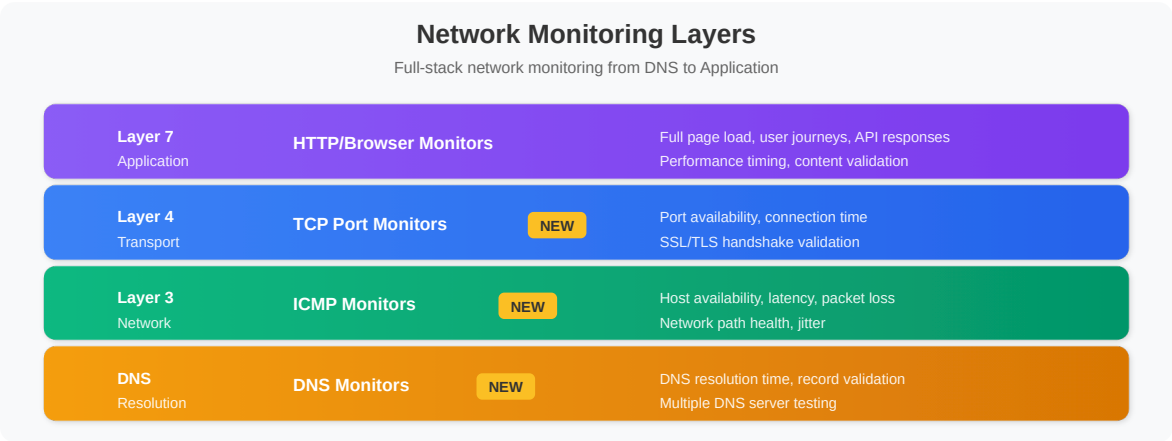
A single **network availability monitor** can verify multiple protocols:

Protocol	Purpose	Use Case
ICMP	Host reachability	Server availability
DNS	Name resolution	DNS infrastructure health
TCP	Port connectivity	Service port availability

All of these run inside one multi-protocol monitor and land in Grail as `multiprotocol_monitor_execution` events — see the data-model note above.

Why Network Monitoring?

Network monitors complement application-level monitoring by testing at different layers of the stack:



Benefits

- **Root Cause Isolation:** Distinguish network vs application issues
- **Infrastructure Validation:** Verify network paths are operational
- **DNS Health:** Monitor critical DNS infrastructure
- **Low Overhead:** Minimal resource consumption
- **High Frequency:** Run every minute if needed

```
// DISCOVERY -- list your network availability (multi-protocol) monitors,
// then inspect the fields a recent execution emits so you know the exact
// protocol-specific result.statistics.* names available in YOUR tenant.
//
// PREFERRED -- Smartscape. The node type is NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR, NOT
// MULTIPROTOCOL_MONITOR: the classic entity was renamed, not transliterated,
// and the
// wrong spelling returns zero rows instead of an error.
smartscapeNodes "NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR"
| fields name, id, id_classic, network_monitor.type, enabled, frequency
| sort name asc
| limit 50

// FALLBACK (classic surface -- deprecated in DQL, supported for as long as
// Dynatrace Classic is supported):
// fetch dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor
// | fields id, entity.name
// | sort entity.name asc
// | limit 50

// To inspect execution fields, run separately:
// fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
// | filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
// | limit 5
```

2. ICMP (Ping) Monitors

What ICMP Monitors Test

Metric	Description
Reachability	Host responds to ping
Latency	Round-trip time (RTT)
Packet Loss	Percentage of lost packets
Jitter	Latency variation

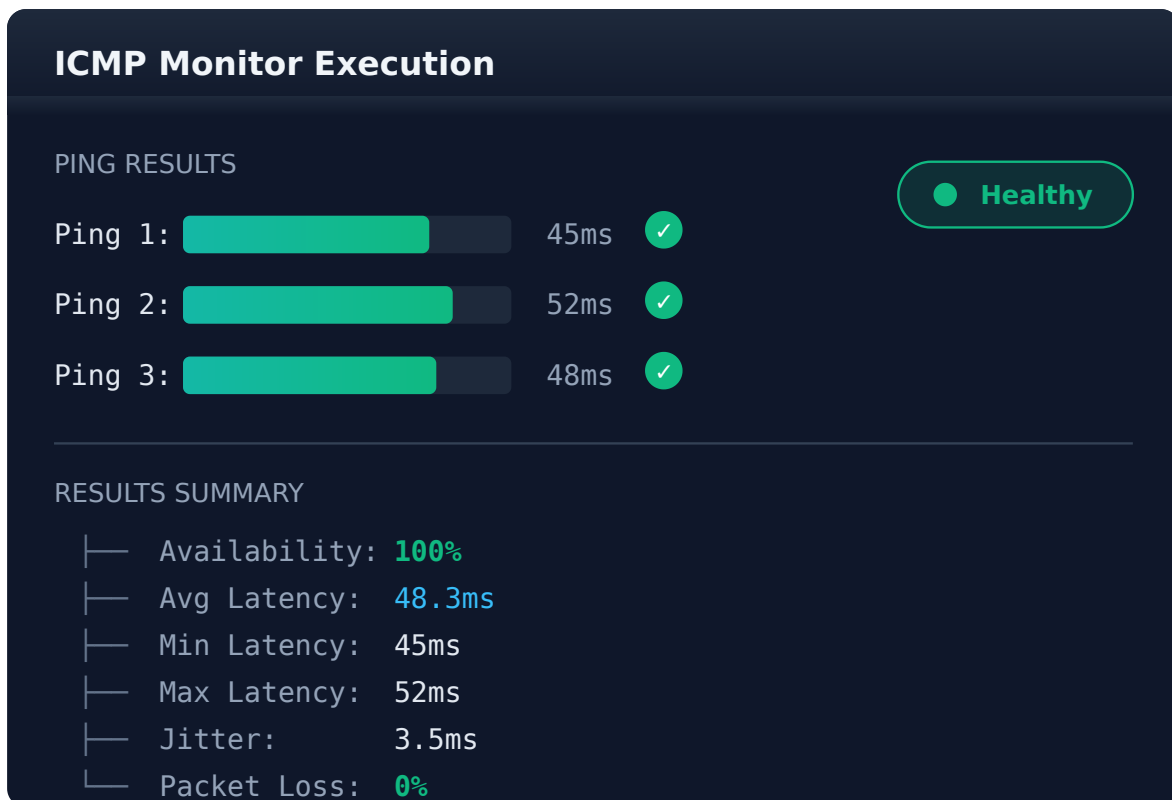
Configuration Options

Setting	Description	Typical Value
Target	IP address or hostname	192.168.1.1 or server.example.com
Packet Count	Pings per execution	3-10
Timeout	Wait time per packet	5 seconds
Frequency	Execution interval	1-60 minutes

Creating an ICMP Monitor

Dynatrace menu → Synthetic → Create synthetic monitor → Create network availability monitor → ICMP

Metrics Captured



```
// Network monitor execution results (last 24h) – multi-protocol events
// Covers ICMP/DNS/TCP checks; result.state reflects overall execution success
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| fields timestamp,
    monitor = monitor.name,
    location = entityName(dt.entity.synthetic_location),
    state = result.state,
    status = result.status.message,
    duration_ms = result.statistics.duration / 1ms
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 100
```

```
// Latency / duration statistics by network monitor (successful executions)
// duration is the execution time; for protocol-specific latency (e.g. ICMP
RTT,
// packet loss) add the field name found via the discovery query above.
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| filter result.state == "SUCCESS"
| summarize {
    avg_ms = avg(result.statistics.duration / 1ms),
    min_ms = min(result.statistics.duration / 1ms),
    max_ms = max(result.statistics.duration / 1ms),
    p95_ms = percentile(result.statistics.duration / 1ms, 95),
    executions = count()
}, by: {monitor.name}
| sort avg_ms desc
| limit 20
```

3. DNS Monitors

What DNS Monitors Test

Check	Description
Resolution	Hostname resolves to IP
Response Time	DNS query duration
Expected IP	Resolves to correct address
Record Type	A, AAAA, CNAME, MX, etc.

Configuration Options

Setting	Description	Example
Hostname	Domain to resolve	api.example.com
DNS Server	Specific resolver (optional)	8.8.8.8
Record Type	DNS record type	A, AAAA, CNAME
Expected IP	Validation (optional)	10.0.0.50
Timeout	Query timeout	10 seconds

DNS Record Types

Type	Purpose	Example
A	IPv4 address	192.168.1.1
AAAA	IPv6 address	2001:db8::1
CNAME	Canonical name	www → app.example.com
MX	Mail exchanger	mail.example.com
TXT	Text records	SPF, DKIM
NS	Name servers	ns1.example.com

```
// Network monitor execution volume by monitor (metric path)
// Scope to your DNS-checking monitors by filtering
dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor
timeseries executions = sum(dt.synthetic.multi_protocol.executions),
    from: now() - 24h, interval: 1h, by: {dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor}
```

```
// Network monitor availability by monitor and location (events path)
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| summarize {
    total = count(),
    successful = countIf(result.state == "SUCCESS")
}, by: {monitor.name, dt.entity.synthetic_location}
| fieldsAdd availability_pct = round((successful * 100.0) / total, decimals:
2)
| fieldsAdd location = entityName(dt.entity.synthetic_location)
| sort availability_pct asc
| limit 30
```

4. TCP Port Monitors

What TCP Monitors Test

Check	Description
Port Open	TCP connection succeeds
Connect Time	Time to establish connection
SSL Handshake	TLS negotiation (if applicable)

Common Ports to Monitor

Port	Service	Use Case
22	SSH	Server management access
80	HTTP	Web server (plain)
443	HTTPS	Web server (secure)
3306	MySQL	Database connectivity
5432	PostgreSQL	Database connectivity
6379	Redis	Cache connectivity
9200	Elasticsearch	Search connectivity

Port	Service	Use Case
27017	MongoDB	Database connectivity

Configuration

Setting	Description	Example
Host	Target server	db.example.com
Port	TCP port number	5432
Timeout	Connection timeout	10 seconds
TLS	Enable TLS check	true/false

```
// Network monitor availability summary by monitor (events path)
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| summarize {
    total = count(),
    successful = countIf(result.state == "SUCCESS"),
    failed = countIf(result.state == "FAIL")
}, by: {monitor.name}
| fieldsAdd availability_pct = round((successful * 100.0) / total, decimals:
2)
| sort availability_pct asc
| limit 20
```

```
// Network monitor execution-volume trend (metric path, last 7 days)
timeseries executions = sum(dt.synthetic.multi_protocol.executions),
    from: now() - 7d, interval: 1h
```

5. Multi-Protocol Monitors

Combining Network Checks

Create comprehensive monitoring by combining multiple protocol checks:

Multi-protocol monitor example — target db.example.com :

Step	Protocol	Target	Check
1	DNS	db.example.com	Resolves to 10.0.1.50
2	ICMP	10.0.1.50	Host reachable
3	TCP	10.0.1.50:5432	PostgreSQL port open

Monitoring Strategy by Layer

Layer	Monitor Type	Purpose
DNS	DNS Monitor	Name resolution works
Network	ICMP Monitor	Host reachable
Transport	TCP Monitor	Service port open
Application	HTTP Monitor	Service responding

6. Use Cases and Patterns

Infrastructure Monitoring

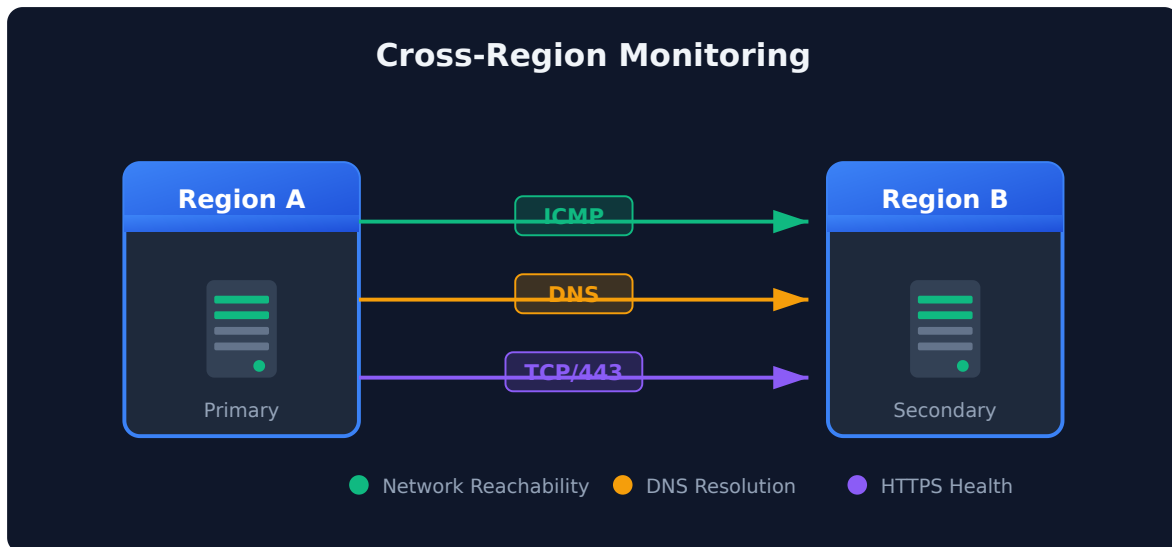
Component	Monitor Type	Target
Load Balancer	TCP/443	VIP address
Database Cluster	TCP/5432	Each node
Cache Layer	TCP/6379	Redis instances
Message Queue	TCP/5672	RabbitMQ nodes

DNS Infrastructure

Scenario	Configuration
Primary DNS	Query internal DNS server
Secondary DNS	Query backup DNS server

Scenario	Configuration
External DNS	Query public resolvers
Record validation	Verify expected IP

Multi-Region Connectivity



```
// All synthetic monitor types summary (HTTP / browser / network)
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter endsWith(event.type, "_monitor_execution")
| summarize {
    total_executions = count(),
    successful = countIf(result.state == "SUCCESS"),
    failed = countIf(result.state == "FAIL")
}, by: {event.type}
| fieldsAdd availability_pct = round((successful * 100.0) / total_executions,
decimals: 2)
| sort total_executions desc
```

7. Analyzing Network Results

```
// Network monitor availability over time (last 7 days)
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 7d
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| makeTimeseries {
    success_count = countIf(result.state == "SUCCESS"),
    total_count = count()
}, interval: 1h, by: {monitor.name}
| fieldsAdd availability_pct = success_count[] * 100.0 / total_count[]
```

```
// Duration trend for network monitors (last 24h)
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| filter result.state == "SUCCESS"
| makeTimeseries {
    avg_ms = avg(result.statistics.duration / 1ms),
    p95_ms = percentile(result.statistics.duration / 1ms, 95)
}, interval: 15m
```

```
// Failed network checks with details
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| filter result.state == "FAIL"
| fields timestamp,
    monitor = monitor.name,
    location = entityName(dt.entity.synthetic_location),
    status = result.status.message,
    detail = result.status.details
| sort timestamp desc
| limit 50
```

```
// Network health score by monitor
fetch dt.synthetic.events, from: now() - 24h
| filter event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"
| summarize {
    total = count(),
    successful = countIf(result.state == "SUCCESS"),
    avg_ms = avg(result.statistics.duration / 1ms)
}, by: {monitor.name}
| fieldsAdd availability_pct = round((successful * 100.0) / total, decimals:
2)
| fieldsAdd avg_ms = round(avg_ms, decimals: 1)
| fieldsAdd health_status = if(availability_pct >= 99.9, "HEALTHY",
    else: if(availability_pct >= 99.0, "DEGRADED",
    else: "CRITICAL"))
| sort availability_pct asc
| limit 30
```

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

✅ **Network availability monitors** - ICMP, DNS, and TCP within one multi-protocol monitor

✅ **The data model** - `event.type == "multiprotocol_monitor_execution"` on `dt.synthetic.events`; metric `dt.synthetic.multi_protocol.executions`; entity `dt.entity.multiprotocol_monitor` (classic) or Smartscape node

NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR (preferred)

✅ **The rename trap** - the Smartscape node is `NETWORK_AVAILABILITY_MONITOR`, not `MULTIPROTOCOL_MONITOR`; a wrong node type returns zero rows, not an error

✅ **Discovery first** - confirm protocol-specific `result.statistics.*` fields in your own tenant

✅ **Multi-protocol patterns** - Comprehensive infrastructure monitoring

✅ **Analysis queries** - Availability, duration, executions, failures, health score

Next Steps

Continue to **SYNTH-06: Analytics & Alerting** to learn about dashboards, SLOs, and alerting strategies.

References

- [Network availability monitoring \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [NAM monitor metrics in Synthetic on Grail \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Synthetic on Grail \(DT docs\)](#)
 - [Synthetic app \(DT docs\)](#)
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